

Social Search Posts Analysis

A descriptive review of 77 X posts collected through multilingual searches for democracy and communism

77	Posts	77 unique post IDs
777,508	Impressions	Across the sampled posts
48,587	Total engagement	Likes, replies, reposts, quotes, bookmarks
6.2%	Weighted rate	Total engagement / impressions

Executive summary

- English posts dominate attention. They account for 21 of 77 posts but 79% of impressions and 96% of engagement.
- Engagement is highly concentrated. The top post contributes 23% of engagement; the top five contribute 63%; and the top ten contribute 86%.
- Communism queries show a higher weighted engagement rate. The rate is 9.0%, compared with 5.0% for democracy queries. This difference is driven mainly by a few high-performing English posts.
- Geographic analysis is provisional. Only 16 of 77 records have location confidence of 0.80 or higher; the median is 0.42. Many locations describe the subject of a post rather than the author.
- The dataset supports pipeline testing better than population inference. Eight queries each contribute approximately ten recent results, producing balance by query but not by the underlying volume of discussion.

Bottom line

The collection demonstrates that multilingual retrieval, translation, engagement extraction, and location enrichment are working together. Its strongest immediate value is methodological: comparing how query wording and language affect what is retrieved. A larger, time-stratified sample is needed before drawing conclusions about public discourse overall.

1. Dataset and collection design

The workbook contains one sheet with 77 X posts and 25 fields. Each record includes post text, an English translation, author information, timestamps, engagement metrics, inferred location, coordinates, the search query, and provenance fields. All records are original posts according to the `is_retweet` field, and all 77 post IDs are unique.

Query term	Concept	Posts	Observed date range (UTC)
democracy	Democracy	10	2026-09-01 to 2026-09-01
communism	Communism	10	2026-09-01 to 2026-09-01
민주	Democracy	10	2026-09-01 to 2026-09-01
공산주의	Communism	9	2026-09-01 to 2026-09-01
ةيطارقم دلا	Democracy	10	2026-09-01 to 2026-09-01
ةيعوي شلا	Communism	10	2026-09-01 to 2026-09-01
민주	Democracy	9	2026-08-31 to 2026-09-01
공산	Communism	9	2026-08-21 to 2026-09-01

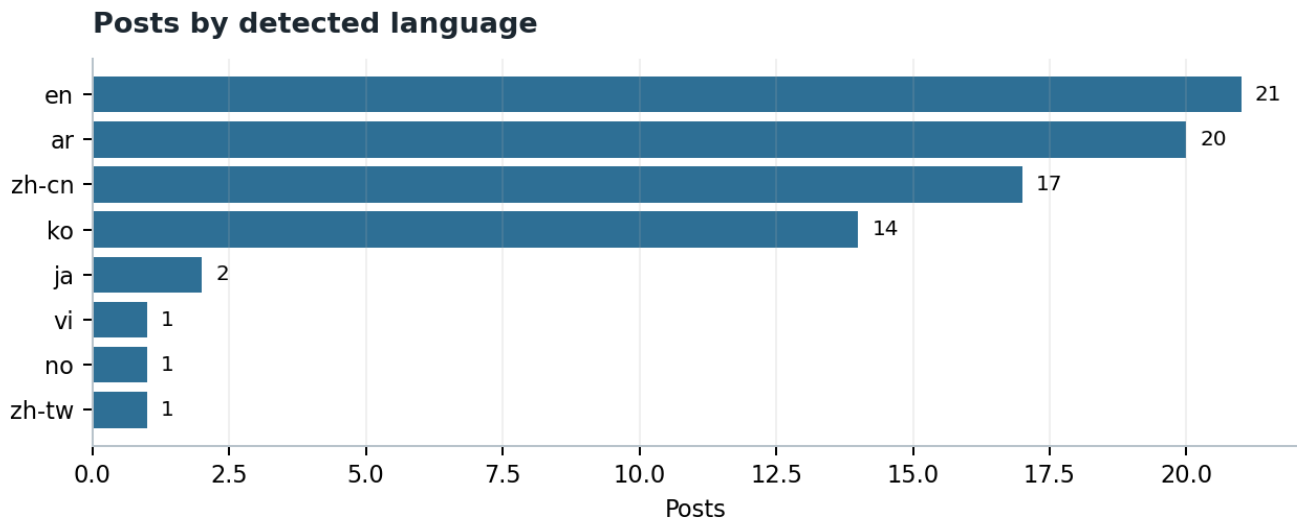
Sampling caveat

The query uses an OR combination of language filters, but the workbook contains Korean, Japanese, Vietnamese, Norwegian, and Traditional Chinese detections in addition to English, Arabic, and Simplified Chinese. This may reflect platform language detection, mixed-language posts, or the way the query was interpreted. The Japanese terms also reach farther back in time because fewer matching records were available. These effects make direct cross-language comparisons especially sensitive to retrieval design.

Data completeness

All core text, query, URL, author, timestamp, and engagement fields are present. Six records lack an inferred location, and nine lack coordinates/geocoded display names. Sixteen posts have zero recorded engagement; 34 have fewer than 1,000 impressions. These are legitimate observations, but they widen the gap between medians and totals.

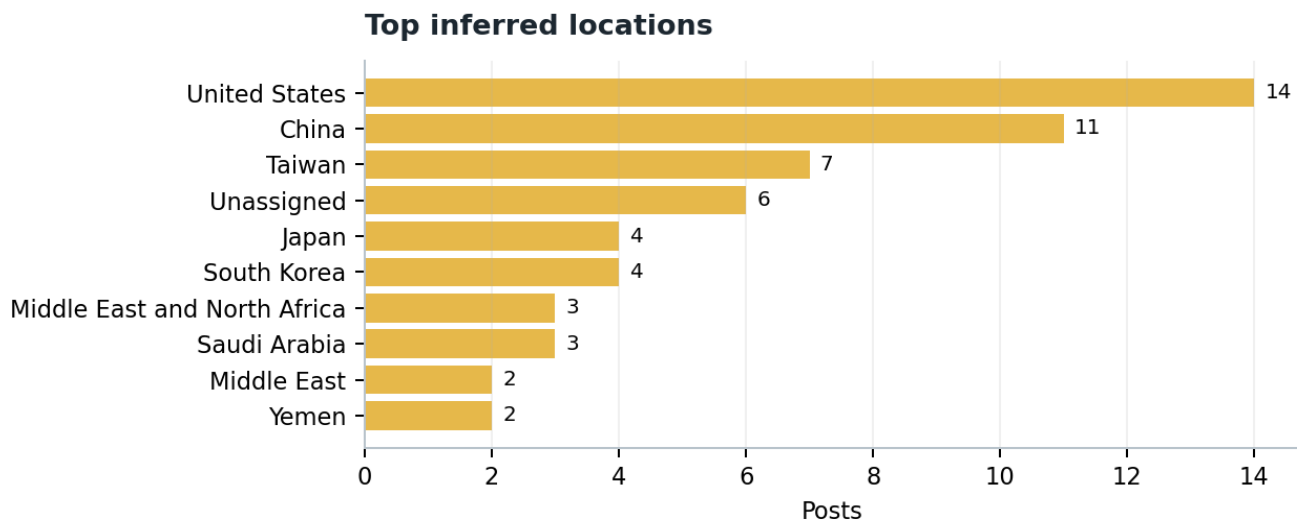
2. Language and geography



Language	Posts	Impressions	Engagement	Weighted rate
en	21	612,498	46,792	7.6%
ar	20	58,230	646	1.1%
zh-cn	17	71,493	1,063	1.5%
ko	14	34,935	80	0.2%
ja	2	318	5	1.6%
vi	1	11	0	0.0%
no	1	12	0	0.0%
zh-tw	1	11	1	9.1%

English results are few in number but dominate reach and response. This should not be interpreted as a platform-wide language effect: the English subset happens to contain nearly all of the highest-reach political accounts in this sample.

Geographic distribution



Location confidence and meaning

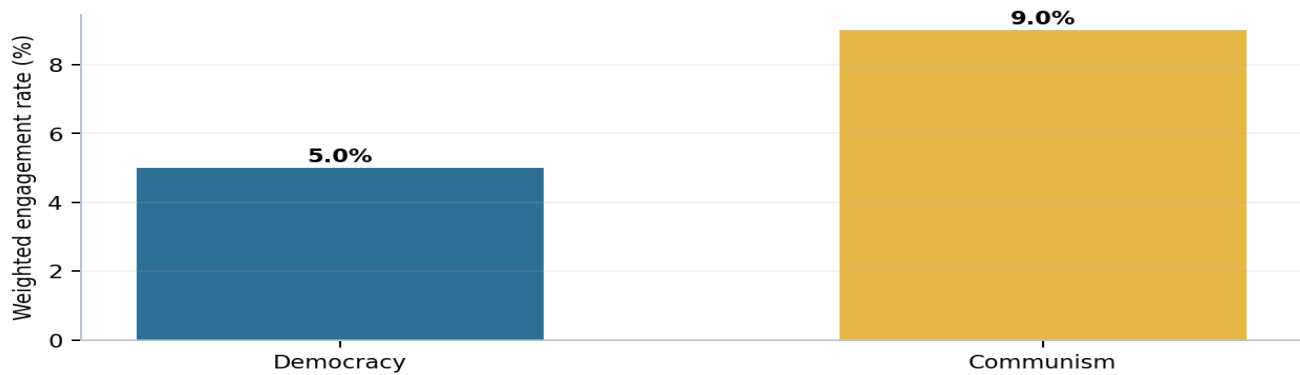
The location field is inferred rather than reported directly. The median confidence is 0.42; 39 records fall below 0.50 and only 16 reach at least 0.80. The reasons frequently infer a place from the topic of the text. For example, a post discussing U.S. politics may be labeled United States even when the author location is unknown. The map-ready coordinates are therefore useful for exploratory visualization, but not yet reliable enough for precise claims about where authors are located.

Recommendation

Separate two concepts in future exports: author location and place discussed. Each should have its own confidence score and evidence type. For author geography, prioritize profile metadata and explicit self-location; use text-based subject inference only for a distinct topic-location field.

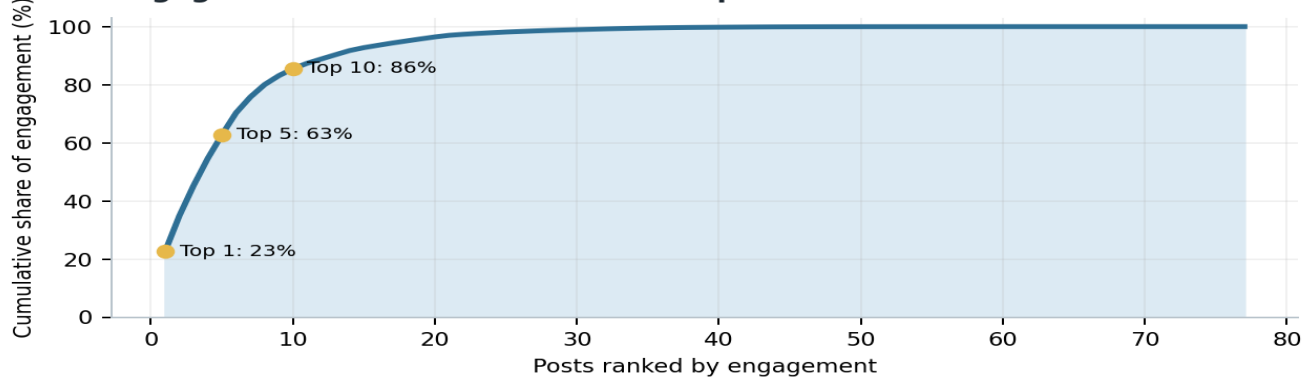
3. Engagement and discourse

Engagement differs sharply by query family



The communism family generates 24% fewer impressions than the democracy family, yet produces 82% as much total engagement. Its higher weighted rate is largely attributable to a handful of English posts about U.S. partisan politics and Hung Cao. The median tells a different story: democracy posts have a 3.0% median engagement rate, compared with 1.4% for communism posts. This contrast between weighted and median rates is evidence of outlier influence.

Engagement is concentrated in a few posts



Account	Concept	Impressions	Engagement	Rate
MAGAVoice	Communism	88,776	10,989	12.4%
BolsonaroSP	Democracy	41,065	5,942	14.5%
SaraAbrams1990	Democracy	100,775	5,054	5.0%
Sassafrass_84	Democracy	32,118	4,542	14.1%
waltermasterson	Communism	23,284	3,970	17.1%

4. Recurring themes

A qualitative reading of the English translations shows several recurring, overlapping frames. Counts are intentionally omitted here because the sample is small and many posts fit more than one category.

Theme	What appears in the sample
U.S. partisan politics	Voting, election administration, Trump, Democratic and Republican actors, federal agencies, and nominees.
Anti-communist political identity	Communism framed as a threat to freedom, national identity, migration stories, and U.S. institutions.
Capitalism-socialism argument	Short, often ironic claims that criticisms of communism actually describe capitalism, plus disputes over definitions.
China and the CCP	Constitutional reform, Tiananmen/1989, anti-CCP activism, historical narratives, and Chinese-language U.S. politics.
Democratic institutions and rights	Elections, polling access, courts, constitutionalism, civil rights, and democratic legitimacy.
MENA political conflict	Yemen, Iran-aligned actors, Sudan, Morocco, Egypt, Palestine, and party politics, often tied to democracy or communism indirectly.

Interpretive finding

The search terms often function less as neutral political concepts than as rhetorical labels. "Democracy" is frequently invoked to legitimize or delegitimize institutions and opponents. "Communism" is often bundled with socialism, capitalism, national identity, or partisan conflict. This makes contextual coding important: keyword frequency alone would flatten distinct uses such as endorsement, condemnation, sarcasm, historical discussion, and incidental naming.

5. Recommendations for the next collection

- Increase depth and stratify time. Collect a consistent number of posts per query per day or hour. This prevents one brief high-attention moment from dominating a language or concept.
- Preserve query-level diagnostics. Record requested count, returned count, pagination status, rate-limit status, and collection timestamp for each query.
- Validate language detection. Store both the platform language and an independent detector, plus a mixed-language flag. Review why Japanese query terms yielded many Korean detections.
- Distinguish location types. Keep author location, place discussed, and geocoding result in separate fields. Do not map topic location as if it were author origin.
- Add stance and usage coding. Suggested fields are concept, stance (support/oppose/neutral/unclear), rhetorical mode (literal/sarcastic/quoted), political context, target, and coder confidence.
- Report robust engagement summaries. Use medians, percentile bands, minimum-impression thresholds, and winsorized or log-scaled views alongside totals and weighted rates.
- Deduplicate narratives as well as post IDs. Near-identical talking points appear across multiple accounts. Add text similarity or cluster IDs to distinguish amplification from independent themes.

Method notes

Engagement is defined as likes + replies + reposts + quotes + bookmarks. Weighted engagement rate is total engagement divided by total impressions. The analysis uses the workbook as provided and does not verify post content, author identity, translation quality, or inferred locations against external sources. Theme analysis is qualitative and overlapping. Dates shown are derived from the stored UTC timestamps.

Source

social_search_posts_20260909_144336.xlsx, sheet "posts" (77 data rows; analyzed September 9, 2026).